

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



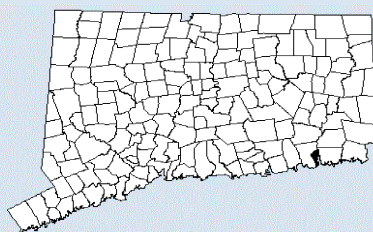
Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Nicholas Spera Sr., Superintendent • 860-447-1003 • <http://www.isaacschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	6-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	279
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,897
Total Expenditures ¹	\$4,747,992

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	147	52.7	48.3
Male	*	*	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	44	15.8	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	172	61.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	22	7.9	4.7
White	36	12.9	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	48	17.2	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	198	71.0	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	50	17.9	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	9	5.9
Male	23	19.3	32	24.6
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	11	25.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	23	14.0	19	10.8
White	10	29.4	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	19.6	6	12.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	32	17.1	32	15.6
Students with Disabilities	14	26.9	16	26.7
District	41	15.5	41	14.4
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 99

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	20.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	4.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	4.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	1.5
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	3.0
School Level	1.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	1.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	16.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	2	6.5	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	3.2	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	4	12.9	0.3
White	24	77.4	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$2,496,902	\$8,886	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$250,324	\$891	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$458,362	\$1,631	\$905
Support services - general administration	.	.	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$445,899	\$1,587	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$633,657	\$2,255	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$448,117	\$1,595	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$14,730	\$52	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$4,747,992	\$16,897	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$325,781	43.6	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$46,240	6.2	10.2
Other Salaries	\$193,056	25.9	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$105,964	14.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$16,850	2.3	6.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.2
Supplies	\$1,759	0.2	0.7
Property Services	\$56,550	7.6	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.4
Equipment	\$268	0.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$746,468	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		15.7	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	15.7
State	65.3
Federal	18.7
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Black or African American	42	64.3	42	52.9	9	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	162	61.7	162	57.4	52	54.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	20	67.2	20	56.7	*	*
White	33	72.9	33	70.1	14	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	82	57.5	82	53.0	22	50.2
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	180	67.6	180	61.0	56	60.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	184	62.2	184	56.5	51	54.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	78	69.7	78	63.2	27	64.7
Students with Disabilities	51	48.7	50	40.2	11	*
Students without Disabilities	211	68.2	212	62.8	67	59.5
High Needs	207	61.6	207	55.5	57	53.4
Non-High Needs	55	75.0	55	69.5	21	69.6
District	262	64.4	262	58.5	78	57.7

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	93.7	97.5	N/A	175	95.4
Curl Up	N/A	94.7	92.5	N/A	175	93.7
Push Up	N/A	70.5	65.0	N/A	175	68.0
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	74.7	56.3	N/A	175	66.3
All Tests - District	N/A	58.9	51.3	N/A	175	55.4
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	64.4	75	43.0	50	85.9	63.9
	High Needs Students	61.6	75	41.1	50	82.2	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	58.5	75	39.0	50	77.9	60.2
	High Needs Students	55.5	75	37.0	50	74.0	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	57.7	75	38.5	50	77.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	53.4	75	35.6	50	71.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	67.9%	100%	67.9	100	67.9	58.7%
	High Needs Students	69.9%	100%	69.9	100	69.9	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	74.7%	100%	74.7	100	74.7	61.4%
	High Needs Students	72.5%	100%	72.5	100	72.5	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	60.7%	100%	30.4	50	60.7	58.9%
	Oral	66.0%	100%	33.0	50	66.0	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	15.5%	<=5%	29.1	50	58.1	17.7%
	High Needs Students	17.0%	<=5%	26.0	50	52.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.0%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		100.0% 55.4%	75%	37.0	50	73.9	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				724.6	1000	72.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.6	13.4	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	69.5	55.5	14.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	69.6	53.4	16.3	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	98.6
Math	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	98.6
Science	All Students	97.5
	High Needs Students	96.6

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Family Engagement:

ISAAC has consistently prioritized engaging families in student learning by implementing various initiatives to foster a strong sense of community. As part of our new Strategic Action Plan, we have placed a significant focus on reaching out to our community using different modes of communication like newsletters. Moreover, we are thrilled to be in the third year of a five-year 21st Century Community Learning Centers Grant, which includes a component specifically dedicated to family outreach. Over the past two years, ISAAC has successfully engaged families through a range of events and activities, such as Community and Family Dance and Dines, Family Meals, and Wellness Workshops. These endeavors have proven to be wonderful opportunities for fostering connections and collaboration between ISAAC families and the broader community. We are excited about our future plans and events that will continue to bring our ISAAC families and the larger school-wide community together.

Communication:

ISAAC, strongly believes that effective communication is fundamental to enhancing and promoting a positive culture and climate among the school, families, and the wider community. ISAAC actively encourages families to join the ISAAC Parent-Teacher Organization (PTO) to foster greater involvement and collaboration. To ensure consistent and timely communication, the school Principal utilizes various social media platforms including Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, reaching out to families with important updates, events, and highlights. Our weekly newsletter, Dragon Tales, keeps families informed about the latest happenings and upcoming events. In addition, ISAAC utilizes School Messenger, letters, and text messages to provide timely and accessible access to school information for ISAAC families. To ensure that we are meeting the needs of our community, ISAAC conducts surveys twice a year, seeking feedback regarding school communication, academics, and safety. Through these comprehensive communication channels and strategies, ISAAC aims to maintain a strong partnership with its families and continuously improve the overall school experience for its students.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication has undergone many efforts to foster a more inclusive and equitable learning environment and reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. One of the strategies we have used is to provide our faculty, staff, and administrators with diversity and inclusion training with a focus on cultural competency and implicit bias to understand and address the unique challenges and needs of students from diverse backgrounds. We have also partnered with the Anti-defamation League to become a “No Place for Hate” school that helps build a learning community of inclusivity, respect, and equity.

Additionally, we have made several attempts at community outreach to actively engage with our families and develop partnerships with community organizations through our after-school programming and recently acquired grants. This helps our students and families feel connected to the school, as evidenced by our recent increased parental engagement survey results. We also actively engage parents and community members through regular communication from our weekly newsletters (English and Spanish versions), social media updates, and regular calls from school. Families are also encouraged to become involved in the decision-making processes by inclusion in organizations like the Parent Teacher Organization. Lastly, families are encouraged to come to the school to participate in school events like our theater, music, and band performances.

Our administrative team regularly meets to conduct equity audits of our disciplinary, attendance, and academic data to ensure equity. We regularly collect and analyze data related to student demographics, academic achievement, and disciplinary actions to identify disparities and assess the effectiveness of implemented strategies. This data-driven approach helps us to identify areas that require further attention and measure progress over time. We have also increased our minority staff and hired additional bilingual, academic, and behavioral interventionists who more closely mirror our students.

We realize that it is important to address racial, ethnic, and economic isolation but know it is an ongoing process that requires sustained commitment and collaboration from all stakeholders.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Ensuring equitable allocation of resources at the Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication is crucial to provide all students with opportunities and support their educational and artistic growth. Here are some key considerations and strategies that can be implemented to achieve equitable resource allocation:

- Needs Assessment: Conduct a comprehensive needs assessment to identify the specific requirements of different student populations. This assessment will help in understanding the unique needs of the students and inform resource allocation decisions.

- Transparent Budgeting: Maintain transparency in the budgeting process by clearly communicating how resources are allocated and involving stakeholders, including students, parents, teachers, and administrators. This ensures that all parties are aware of the available resources and how they will be distributed.

- Adequate Funding: Advocate for adequate funding to support our students. This can involve writing grants to secure additional funding for the school. Sufficient resources enable the school to provide quality programs, materials, and facilities for all students.